TA studio brief — The local canvas: architectural line and form

Pathway: TRACK · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How can we use structural line, negative space, and surface frottage to record built architecture?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide clear acetate grids that pupils can lay over architectural reference photos to spot the negative-space triangles.

Studio kit: Architectural structure reference cards, textured relief plates, 2B/4B pencils, fineliners, wide graphite sticks, cartridge paper

Key words to prompt

• negative space: The open air gaps and shapes trapped between solid beams.

• truss: A rigid framework of steel or timber beams arranged in repeating triangles.

• line weight: Varying line thickness from light construction lines to heavy foreground edges.

• frottage: Taking a surface texture rubbing with graphite or wax over a relief surface.

• proportion: The size relationship between height, span, and beam thickness.

Supported route steps

1. Rub a light graphite texture across your page using two textured plates.

2. Use the triangle negative-space guide to map the inner gaps of a truss span.

3. Join the beams around the gaps using a ruler and black fineliner.

4. Thicken the front beam edges so they stand out over the texture ground.

Check: Texture ground with accurate negative-space truss drawing and varied line weight.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What do we call the open sky shapes trapped between the solid beams of a structure?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review a short demonstration on using negative-space triangles and varied line weight to draw engineered trusses.